

SHOPPAGE

Zimbabwe Commerce Intelligence, Discovery, Media and Market Infrastructure

National Launch Master Business Model v1.0 - Preloaded Intelligence and Execution Edition

Date: 10 July 2026

Status: Binding strategy, national data-readiness doctrine and controlled-launch implementation blueprint

Supersedes: Holistically Reviewed Master v0.9 as the operating master

Core decision: Shoppage will not launch as an empty marketplace waiting for merchants to create its value. It will launch as a Zimbabwe-owned commerce operating system preloaded with a rights-governed national reference graph: more than one million master-product identities, at least ten thousand claim-ready organisation and merchant profiles, a national place scaffold, known markets and market-in-market structures, historical commerce evidence, and cold-start AI recommendations. Merchant-specific prices, stock, fulfilment and current operating claims remain time-bound local offer truth. Shoppage must remain operational if Facebook, Google, TikTok or any other external distribution platform is unavailable.

Document control and review outcome

This edition retains the holistic v0.9 review and makes the launch-data position explicit. It incorporates the validated Commerce Intelligence Foundation, the 10 July 2026 implementation progress report and the binding decision that Shoppage will enter the market with substantial preloaded product, organisation, place, market and historical intelligence rather than an empty catalogue. The v0.7 document remains an evidence compendium and v0.9 remains the reviewed predecessor, but v1.0 is the current operating master.

The review made five structural corrections:

1. Replaced repeated executive, final-decision, roadmap, risk, AI, investor and architecture sections with one binding version of each.
2. Separated **validated foundation evidence**, **current production truth**, **launch hypotheses** and **long-term ambitions**.
3. Reframed “fully functional in three months” as a **controlled, end-to-end commercial launch within a narrow geography and category wedge**, not national completeness.
4. Made payments, fulfilment, merchant websites, Pemosites and the platform-framework model explicit architectural decisions.
5. Converted the large catalogue of ideas into a prioritised portfolio with launch, expansion and post-six-month horizons.
6. Made Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok, Google and other external platforms optional adapters rather than identity, content or demand foundations.
7. Kept the five named Shoppage domains internally while simplifying the public proposition to one brand and three jobs: Sell, Discover and Grow.
8. Replaced launch-stage creator commissions with fixed, verifiable content and merchant-digitisation bounties; outcome commissions begin only after attribution and fraud controls pass.
9. Reframed institutional ambition as National Impact Readiness, with explicit protections against political capture, privileged ranking and surveillance use.
10. Locked a preloaded-launch doctrine: master products, organisation profiles, national places and known markets are loaded before public launch.
11. Defined merchant claiming, correction, duplicate resolution and evidence-preserving profile ownership.
12. Added a Historical Commerce Archive and source-governance rules for directories, public social evidence, collaborators and purchased data.
13. Made a cold-start recommendation engine and a rights-cleared Zimbabwe commerce intelligence model part of launch architecture.
14. Converted “succeed against all odds” into a mission-critical execution doctrine with redundancy, manual fallbacks, weekly gates and explicit truth controls.

Binding interpretation rule

Where this document uses the words **must**, **will** or **non-negotiable**, the statement is a current product or governance decision. Where it uses **target**, **hypothesis**, **candidate**, **pilot** or **later**, the statement requires validation before it becomes a binding commitment.

Evidence and public-display ladder

- **Foundation validated:** a schema, pipeline, count or test has been reproduced. Use it for architecture, engineering and launch preparation.
- **Preloaded reference:** a rights-cleared master product, classification, place or historical reference exists. Use it for search, enrichment and recommendations with reference labels.
- **Sourced candidate:** one or more sources indicate an organisation, market, branch or relationship may exist. Use it for a claim-ready profile, internal review and cautious public discovery.
- **Corroborated profile:** an authoritative source or multiple independent sources support defined identity, location or contact predicates. It may be displayed publicly as an unclaimed profile with source and freshness labels.
- **Merchant-claimed:** an authorised representative controls current merchant-managed fields. It may power the Merchant Site, catalogue and operational updates subject to audit.
- **Verified current claim:** a specific predicate has current supporting evidence. It may receive public badges and ranking treatment within the stated scope.
- **Production truth:** a verified claim is fresh and operationally safe. It may affect search ranking, ads, recommendations, payments and fulfilment.

Shoppage will launch with substantial preloaded references and corroborated profiles. It will not collapse these states into one blanket “verified” badge. A directory entry, map point, Facebook page, model output or imported record verifies only the predicate supported by its source and date.

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1. Executive verdict and scope

1.1 What Shoppage is

Shoppage is a local commerce-intelligence, discovery, media and operating platform. It contains five internal product domains with a reusable framework beneath them. These domains organise teams, permissions, APIs and economics; they are not five separate consumer products that users must learn.

Internal domain	Primary function	External promise
Shoppage Central	Merchant operating system and authoritative Merchant Site	Sell and maintain commercial truth
Shoppage Showcase	Search, geolocal discovery, requests and shoppable short video	Discover what is available, nearby and credible
Shoppage Ads	Local commerce advertising and attribution	Grow through measurable local outcomes
Shoppage Creators	Content production, community distribution and later affiliate commerce	Grow through trusted local voices
Shoppage Markets	Digital operating layer for malls, markets and clusters	Sell and discover within real commercial places

The **Shoppage Framework** supplies shared identity, places, products, offers, search, trust, advertising, payments, fulfilment, intelligence, AI, billing and audit capabilities to the five domains and later approved extensions. Public communication uses one Shoppage brand and three verbs: **Sell, Discover and Grow**.

1.2 What Shoppage is not

During the first six months Shoppage is not:

- a national fulfilment fleet;
- a deposit-taking wallet or unlicensed escrow provider;
- a general entertainment social network;
- an unrestricted public plugin store;
- an unqualified claim that every preloaded organisation is currently trading or every master product is currently sold in Zimbabwe;
- an owner of every merchant transaction;
- a custom website agency disguised as software;
- a political advertising platform;
- a broad marketplace launching every category simultaneously.

1.3 Controlled-launch definition

“Fully functional in months 0-3” means the following end-to-end flows work in a controlled Harare launch:

- a merchant can discover or claim a preloaded profile, resolve ownership, create an authoritative Merchant Site, publish products and confirm price and stock;
- a buyer can search the preloaded master catalogue and national organisation/place graph, distinguish reference products from current local offers, browse short videos, compare local options, submit a request and contact a merchant;
- a merchant can buy a simple promotion and see attributable results;
- a creator can complete a contracted content, catalogue or merchant-onboarding bounty, while tagged links collect measurement data for later commission models;
- a market can have a verified page, roster and campaign surface;

- payment initiation and fulfilment options can be orchestrated through partners;
- evidence, provenance, source rights, correction, merchant claiming, moderation and audit trails are operational;
- the platform can measure search-to-contact, merchant response, freshness, recommendation quality, profile claims and verified outcomes.

It does not mean nationwide depth, every product category, mature transaction protection, public APIs or automated intelligence across the entire economy.

1.4 Launch wedge

The recommended launch wedge remains **Home, Power and Building** in Harare:

- solar, batteries and inverters;
- electrical and plumbing supplies;
- hardware and building materials;
- selected appliances and furniture;
- installation, repair and improvement services.

This wedge has high buyer intent, meaningful local availability differences, quote-based purchasing, compatibility questions, strong video-demonstration value, sufficient merchant margins for advertising, and diaspora relevance.

Shoppage will nevertheless launch with a searchable reference catalogue of more than one million master-product identities. The attached foundation independently validates exactly 1,000,000 global food-product masters from one source. The binding pre-launch target is to retain that validated base, add several rights-cleared product and classification sources, and prioritise non-food master, variant, compatibility and attribute coverage for Home, Power and Building. Reference scale and local availability are separate: a master product may be discoverable even when no Zimbabwe merchant offer exists, but it must display “no current local offer observed” rather than imply stock. The local launch wedge remains the priority for fresh branch-linked prices, availability, services and fulfilment.

1.5 Launch and month-three operating envelope

Target area	Binding launch/month-three target	Interpretation
Master products	1,000,000+ indexed master identities	Reference layer; source and licence preserved; local availability never inferred
Product-source diversity	Several rights-cleared sources plus Shoppage enrichment	Avoid single-source dependence and improve non-food launch categories
Organisations/merchants	10,000+ claim-ready profiles	Identity/location/contact predicates are source-labelled; current trading state remains time-bound
Activated merchants	50-100 claimed, responsive merchants	Quality and response matter more than total imported profiles
Local offers	3,000-5,000 fresh, branch-linked offers	Each has price/availability evidence and freshness state
Places	National place scaffold loaded	Source coverage is complete for designated datasets; real-world completeness remains correctable
Markets/clusters	All known public markets from designated sources, with 5-10 deeply operational pages	Market-in-market containment requires evidence, not proximity guesses
Creators	20-40 trained and approved	Focused on useful product content, digitisation and distribution
Commerce clips	250-500 catalogue-linked clips	Low-data, moderated, attributable and rights-cleared

Target area	Binding launch/month-three target	Interpretation
Recommendation engine	Cold-start production recommender active	Uses product, location, availability, trust and explicit intent before behavioural scale exists
Merchant claiming	Ownership, correction, merge and dispute flow live	Claimed control does not erase source history or third-party evidence
Payment rails	At least two practical provider/rail options	Shoppage does not hold customer funds
Fulfilment modes	Collection, merchant delivery and partner quote	Asset-light orchestration
Freshness	At least 80% of visible local offers within category window	Stale offers are downgraded or hidden

These are operating targets. Product-reference scale, profile scale and place coverage are front-loaded assets; commercial success is measured by claimed profiles, fresh offers, resolved needs, repeat use and revenue.

2. Zimbabwe ground reality

The model must work with current Zimbabwean commerce rather than imported assumptions. Public evidence describes e-commerce as predominantly urban and informal, with Facebook Marketplace and WhatsApp central to product discovery and negotiation, and cash, cash on delivery and mobile payments common in place of card-first website checkout.[1]

Digital 2026 estimates 6.54 million individual internet users, 2.60 million social-media user identities and 16.2 million active cellular connections in late 2025. These figures support a meaningful mobile opportunity but do not justify designing as though every connection is an active online shopper or every user has stable broadband.[2]

UNCTAD identifies diaspora demand, weakly structured logistics, informal service providers, last-mile gaps, a need for pickup centres, digital-skills constraints and an incomplete e-commerce legal environment.[3]

2.1 Design consequences

Ground reality	Required Shoppage response	Failure avoided
Commerce starts on social channels	Shareable product cards, clips and links that return to Shoppage truth	Demanding immediate channel abandonment
Trust is local and relationship-based	Progressive verification, locations, response history and proof-backed reviews	Anonymous-listing marketplace behaviour
Connectivity and data are uneven	Low-data mode, manual location, compressed media and resilient forms	Video-heavy experience that excludes users
Payments are mixed	Cash, collection, mobile money, transfer and provider checkout	Mandatory card-first funnel
Logistics are fragmented	Quote, collection and partner orchestration	Premature national fleet
Merchant digital capability varies	Assisted onboarding, voice/image ingestion and managed campaigns	Self-service-only adoption model
Currency conditions change	Multi-currency data model and dated exchange assumptions	Hard-coded currency logic
Public business data is fragmented and uneven	Preload several sources, preserve evidence, enable merchant claims, field verification and public corrections	Pretending one directory or scrape is national truth

2.2 Inclusion requirements

Shoppage should be smartphone-first, not smartphone-exclusive in its operating model. Core inclusion measures are:

- text-first and low-data browsing;
- manual city, suburb, landmark and market selection;
- agent-assisted onboarding and verification;
- shareable links that work without an installed app;
- English at launch with progressive Shona and Ndebele search, prompts and support;
- voice-note and image-assisted merchant ingestion;
- clear price dates and currency labels;
- no forced buyer registration before search or contact.

3. Vision, mission and brand architecture

3.1 Vision

Make Zimbabwean commerce visible, searchable, trusted, measurable and locally valuable.

3.2 Mission

Shoppage will organise merchant identity, places, products, services, offers, demand, content and commercial outcomes into a continuously improving local commerce graph. It will use that graph to help buyers resolve needs, help merchants grow, help creators earn, help markets digitise and help local institutions understand commerce without selling personal data.

3.3 Positioning

For buyers: find what is available, where it is, who can be trusted and how to obtain it.

For merchants: publish once, maintain commercial truth, reach local demand and measure every meaningful action.

3.4 Brand rules

Shoppage is the master brand. Central, Showcase, Ads, Creators and Markets are internal product domains and specialist workspaces, not five competing consumer brands or separate public companies. One identity, catalogue, trust system, billing relationship and analytics model must operate across all domains.

Public product language is deliberately simpler:

- **Sell:** create and maintain a Merchant Site, catalogue, market presence, leads, payment and fulfilment options.
- **Discover:** search, browse nearby availability, watch useful commerce media, compare options and post requests.
- **Grow:** promote products, commission content, understand demand and improve merchant performance.

A buyer should never be required to decide whether to open “Showcase” or “Markets”; the buyer searches Shoppage. A merchant should not need to understand an internal domain map before publishing or promoting an offer. Domain names remain useful in architecture, investor and partner materials, and in specialist workspaces where the distinction improves operations.

Recommended digital structure:

- `shoppage.co.zw` - public discovery, requests, market pages and Merchant Sites;
- `manage.shoppage.co.zw` - merchant Sell workspace;
- `grow.shoppage.co.zw` - advertising, creator and growth workspace, with role-specific views;
- `developers.shoppage.co.zw` - later controlled developer portal;
- market pages at `shoppage.co.zw/markets/{slug}`.

Separate ads and creators subdomains may exist operationally, but they should not be the primary public acquisition message. Routes may share one deployment during the first three months. Domain, company-name and trademark due diligence are required before major brand investment.

4. Shoppage system architecture

4.1 Shared horizontal engines

The five internal domains depend on common engines. Duplicating these engines inside each domain would weaken the moat and increase cost.

Shared engine	Responsibility	Non-negotiable control
Identity and organisations	People, merchants, branches, roles and claims	Tenant isolation and auditable authority
Places and markets	Geography, service areas, markets and containment	Evidence-based relationships, not proximity guesses
Catalogue and offers	Masters, variants, services, prices and stock	Product identity separated from seller offer
Search and discovery	Keyword, semantic, geolocal and request matching	Relevance and freshness before paid influence
Trust and safety	Verification, reports, complaints and reputation	Human appeal for high-impact decisions
Content and media	Images, short video, captions and rights	Every commerce clip links to structured objects
Advertising and attribution	Campaigns, placements, spend and outcomes	Transparent labels and relevance floors
Payments and fulfilment	Provider initiation, quotes, statuses and evidence	No unlicensed custody or hidden off-platform handoff
Intelligence and AI	Enrichment, recommendations, forecasting and copilots	Evidence, evaluation and human review
Billing and entitlements	Plans, limits, credits and partner fees	Clear invoices and auditable balances

4.2 Primary participants

- buyers and household purchasers;
- informal and formal merchants;
- branches, stalls and service providers;
- creators, affiliates and community operators;
- markets, malls and commercial clusters;
- brands, distributors and manufacturers;
- payment, fulfilment, POS and service partners;
- Shoppage field, moderation, support and data teams;
- approved powered businesses and subsidiaries.

4.3 Core journeys

Merchant journey

Preload and resolve organisation/branch -> expose claim-ready profile -> authorised representative claims or corrects it -> verify relevant predicates -> create authoritative Merchant Site -> attach masters/variants and current offers -> confirm freshness -> publish content -> receive leads -> promote -> record outcomes -> improve from intelligence.

Buyer journey

Search, browse or ask -> choose location and constraints -> inspect product, merchant and freshness -> compare total outcome -> contact, request, reserve or initiate payment -> choose collection/delivery -> receive proof and support -> save need or review outcome.

Creator journey

Apply and verify -> select approved merchant/product -> create or upload content -> disclose commercial relationship -> tag canonical objects -> publish -> generate attributable action -> pass fraud/dispute window -> receive payout.

Market journey

Resolve operator and boundary -> create market structure -> onboard merchants/stalls -> publish market page -> maintain roster and hours -> run market campaigns -> measure traffic, demand and merchant outcomes.

4.4 Independence doctrine

Shoppage must operate as a complete core product without Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok, Google or any other external platform. External platforms can accelerate acquisition and distribution, but they cannot be required for identity, canonical content, search, requests, leads, merchant maintenance or outcome history.

Identity is owned by Shoppage

- Every user, merchant, branch, creator and partner has a canonical Shoppage identifier.
- Phone or email OTP and Shoppage credentials are the default login paths; social login is optional convenience only.
- Facebook Page IDs, WhatsApp business numbers, Google Business IDs and other platform identifiers are stored as revocable **external_identity** records with source, scope, confidence and last-verification state.
- No external-platform identifier may be a database primary key or the only recovery route.
- Identity evidence follows data minimisation. National ID or equivalent evidence is requested only when a defined risk, regulatory or transaction rule requires it, preferably through an approved verifier without retaining unnecessary raw documents.

Content is owned by Shoppage

The Merchant Site, product, variant, offer, market, creator asset and campaign record are canonical. A Facebook post, WhatsApp share, TikTok clip, Google feed or other external representation is a render or referral of the Shoppage record. External content must link back to a stable Shoppage object whenever platform rules permit. Imported observations never silently overwrite merchant-authorised current truth; they create evidence or review events. Merchant claims likewise do not erase older evidence, regulatory facts, complaint records or source provenance.

Demand is owned by Shoppage

Direct demand must be created through capabilities external social platforms cannot reliably provide together:

1. **Freshness truth:** visible last-confirmed price and stock, category-specific expiry, one-tap merchant reconfirmation and automatic ranking downgrade for stale offers.
2. **Operational proximity:** open-now state, realistic distance, branch availability, accepted payment methods, collection and delivery feasibility, response performance and local landmarks.
3. **Structured Request Network:** buyers state an exact need, location, timing and constraints; Shoppage routes it to eligible merchants, records responses and learns unresolved demand.

External adapters are optional translators

Where a platform permits compliant APIs, Shoppage may read or publish through a scoped adapter. Where it does not, Shoppage provides user-initiated sharing, export cards, copy-ready text, canonical links and QR codes. Unauthorised scraping, credential sharing or automation that violates platform terms is not a core growth strategy.

Core domains: Identity, Organisation, Product, Offer, Request, Lead, Content, Outcome

Optional adapters: Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok, Google, POS, ERP, payments, fulfilment

Rule: core events may be exported to adapters; critical core flows never require adapter availability

Kill switch: disabling any adapter must not block login, publish, search, request, lead or maintenance

4.5 Independence acceptance criteria

Before controlled launch:

- the application boots and core buyer/merchant flows pass with all social adapters disabled;
- no social login or external ID is required to recover an account;
- every outbound social object resolves to a canonical Shoppage URL or documented export artifact;
- adapter timeout, revocation and policy-change tests do not corrupt core data;
- the installable PWA can display previously cached Merchant Sites, products, saved needs and operating information while temporarily offline; merchant draft changes can queue locally and sync safely when connectivity returns;
- full server search, payment status and live availability are never falsely presented as current while offline;
- merchant data and media can be exported in a documented format;
- an external-platform concentration dashboard tracks referral dependence and direct/owned return traffic.

5. Shoppage Central

Shoppage Central is the merchant operating system and must create standalone value before Shoppage has national buyer traffic.

5.1 Merchant Site as authoritative commercial reference

Every activated merchant receives a Shoppage Merchant Site that can serve as the reference website for the business. It includes:

- verified business and branch profile;
- products, variants, services, prices and freshness;
- images, short videos, offers and collections;
- maps, hours, delivery zones and collection options;
- payment methods and transaction options;
- WhatsApp, call, request-quote and reservation actions;
- policies, warranties, FAQs and trust signals;
- structured metadata for public search engines;
- QR code and shareable links;
- analytics and campaign attribution.

A Merchant Site is not a decorative profile. It is the first-party publishing surface for commercial truth.

5.2 Merchant workspace

Workspace	Core functions	Launch control
Today	Leads, stale stock, price checks and urgent actions	Daily action queue
Catalogue	Products, variants, services, media and imports	Draft, review and audit history
Offers	Price, currency, availability, branch and validity	Freshness and evidence state
Content	Clips, cards, captions, collections and QR	Rights and moderation checks
Leads	Calls, WhatsApp, RFQs, reservations and notes	Source attribution and status
Ads	Simple objectives, budget, geography and reports	Spend caps and relevance checks
Creators	Invitations, bounty contracts, assets and later commissions	Contract, disclosure and release-gate state
Intelligence	Demand, gaps, response and improvement actions	Confidence and privacy controls
Settings	Staff, roles, branches, policies and integrations	Least privilege and audit log

5.3 Merchant ingestion

Merchants should be able to publish through:

- manual mobile entry;
- spreadsheet or CSV;
- authorised POS, ERP or distributor feed;

- image or PDF extraction with confirmation;
- voice note or WhatsApp-assisted draft;
- agent-assisted field capture;
- later API or plugin integration.

AI may draft titles, attributes, categories and variants, but the merchant or authorised operator confirms commercial claims before publication.

5.4 Freshness system

Each visible offer has:

- observed or confirmed time;
- price-valid-until where appropriate;
- stock state and confidence;
- branch or service area;
- evidence source;
- stale-after rule by category;
- merchant reconfirmation path;
- customer correction/report path.

Freshness states should be **confirmed**, **recent**, **aging**, **stale**, **unknown** or **disputed**. Search and ads must downgrade or exclude stale and disputed offers.

5.5 Merchant improvement loop

Central should tell a merchant what to do next, not merely show charts. Examples:

- confirm 14 offers that will expire tomorrow;
- reply to three high-intent requests;
- add a missing inverter capacity attribute;
- create a 20-second demonstration for a frequently viewed product;
- extend delivery to an area with unresolved demand;
- stop an ad whose stock is no longer available;
- compare response time with the category benchmark.

6. Shoppage Showcase

Showcase is the buyer front door: commercial search, nearby discovery, requests, collections and low-data short-form commerce video.

6.1 Buyer surfaces

Surface	Buyer job	Launch requirement
Search	Find a product, variant, service or supplier	Typo tolerance, synonyms, geo and freshness
Nearby	See credible availability around a place	Manual location and realistic radius
Showcase feed	Discover useful product content	Catalogue-linked clips only
Product page	Understand exact item and offer	Variant, price date, stock and vendor
Merchant Site	Evaluate the seller	Branches, policies, trust and contact
Market page	Browse a mall, market or cluster	Verified roster, map and content
Ask/Request	Describe an unmet need	Structured routing and response tracking
Saved needs	Return when availability or price changes	Consent-based alerts
Compare	Compare total outcome	Price, trust, location, warranty and delivery

6.2 Geolocal commerce

Geo must affect search, requests and advertising, but location precision must be proportionate and consent-based. The graph should support:

- country, province, city, suburb, growth point and landmark;
- market, mall, building, section, stall and branch;
- pickup points and verified collection points;
- merchant delivery zones and service radii;
- routes and corridors for peri-urban and rural fulfilment;
- “open now”, “available today” and realistic travel/delivery filters;
- coverage cells by category and place.

GPS is optional. Manual location is mandatory.

6.3 Short-form commerce video

Showcase video is commerce media, not general entertainment. Every clip must connect to a product, service, merchant, market, collection, offer or request.

Launch formats:

- product demonstration;
- new-stock or price-drop alert;
- store or market walk-through;
- installation or before-and-after proof;
- comparison or buying guide;
- creator review with disclosure;
- frequently asked question;
- availability update.

Operational rules:

- normally 10-60 seconds;
- muted autoplay only where data settings allow;
- captions and thumbnails required;
- low-data mode and conservative preloading;
- content rights recorded;
- current price/stock overlay or stale-content warning;
- clear creator/advertiser disclosure;
- reporting on views, saves, catalogue opens, contacts and outcomes.

6.4 Native demand wedge

Showcase must earn direct use before it attempts broad media scale. The first buyer promise is: **find the credible nearby option that can serve me now, or route my request to someone who can**. Freshness truth, operational proximity and the Request Network are therefore launch-critical; the video feed is supportive discovery, not the primary retention mechanism.

Direct-use tests should measure whether a buyer can resolve a need faster and with less uncertainty than posting in a group, scrolling old listings or calling several shops.

7. Shoppage Ads

Shoppage Ads is the mechanism for moving a measurable share of Zimbabwean commercial advertising spend from broad global attention platforms into local, outcome-oriented commerce media.

7.1 Advertising doctrine

- Sell commercial intent and attributable action, not vanity engagement.
- Protect organic relevance; payment cannot make an irrelevant result useful.
- Promote only eligible merchants, products, services and content.
- Display paid labels clearly.
- Use simple objectives for SMEs and deeper controls for larger advertisers later.
- Report the buyer action that followed the ad.
- Exclude political advertising during the initial operating period.
- Maintain an independent ad-integrity function with authority to reject revenue.

7.2 Launch products

Ad product	Best use	Initial charging model
Sponsored product	High-intent category or keyword demand	Budget/click or fixed package
Sponsored Merchant Site	Store or branch visibility	Fixed duration or impression package
Sponsored clip	Product demonstration and launch	Budget/view with action reporting
Nearby deal	Local availability and store traffic	Area-duration package
Market sponsorship	Market, mall or commercial-cluster promotion	Contracted package
Request matching	Qualified buyer request access	Qualified lead or subscription
Managed campaign	Merchants lacking internal capability	Service fee plus media budget
Creator campaign	Creator-produced catalogue-linked content	Fixed bounty at launch; verified-outcome commission only after gates

7.3 Simple campaign workflow

1. Select objective: visibility, catalogue visit, WhatsApp lead, call, quote, reservation or verified sale later.
2. Select the product, Merchant Site, market or clip.
3. Choose location, category, duration and budget.
4. Receive automatic quality, stock, policy and reach checks.
5. Publish automatically for low-risk trusted advertisers or enter review.
6. Apply frequency limits and organic-result safeguards.
7. Report spend, reach, actions, merchant response and verified outcomes.
8. Provide recommendations without silently changing budget or targeting.

7.4 Substitution metrics

- **Commercial Discovery Share:** share of covered-category buyer needs resolved through Shoppage.
- **Merchant Advertising Wallet Share:** share of a merchant's measurable acquisition budget allocated to Shoppage.
- **Local Advertising Value Retention:** advertiser revenue remaining in Zimbabwe after direct imported infrastructure, processing and software costs.

Shoppage should not claim that every advertising dollar remains in Zimbabwe. The credible claim is that more campaign capability, data, jobs, creator payouts, partner revenue, tax and merchant relationships are retained locally.

7.5 Cold-start advertising rule

Ads cannot succeed without useful organic demand. During months 0-3, revenue should come from managed campaigns, market packages, onboarding bundles and clearly limited sponsored placements. Large-scale self-service advertising should expand only after search volume, repeat users and outcome measurement are credible.

8. Shoppage Creators

Creators are a core distribution, education, merchant-digitisation and content-production network. Facebook group administrators, WhatsApp community operators, product reviewers, technicians, videographers, market walkers, campus promoters and specialist communities already hold trusted local attention. Shoppage should convert that capability into structured commerce without building a launch-stage affiliate-fraud engine.

8.1 Creator roles

Role	Value created	Initial earning method
Commerce creator	Product demonstrations and reviews	Contracted content bounty
Market creator	Market walk-throughs and merchant discovery	Market content package
Specialist creator	Technical buying education	Contracted guide/video fee
Catalogue creator	Merchant media and product-data capture	Accepted-work service fee
Community operator	Relevant distribution to a trusted audience	Approved post/distribution bounty
Affiliate curator	Collections and tagged recommendations	Measurement pilot, then qualified-outcome commission

8.2 Tier 1 - months 0-3: fixed, verifiable bounties

Launch compensation is based on accepted work, not clicks, views or unverified sales. Example packages include one catalogue-linked video, a defined number of compliant community posts, a merchant onboarding, a market walk-through or a product-data capture assignment.

A bounty is payable only when:

- the merchant, products, deliverables, rights and fee are agreed in advance;
- the creator uses the canonical Shoppage Universal Link or QR asset;
- sponsored disclosure is present;
- the content remains available for the contracted verification period, normally at least 48 hours unless the platform removes it;
- Shoppage verifies the deliverable and there is no rights, fraud or safety breach.

Tagged links and events are collected from day one for learning, but they do not automatically determine creator pay during the initial period. This keeps creators funded while attribution quality is being proven.

8.3 Tier 2 - months 4-6: verified lead commissions

Outcome-based commissions begin only after unique-link attribution, duplicate detection, merchant response workflows, dispute handling and payout reconciliation pass release gates. Eligible commission events may include a structured qualified lead, accepted quote, completed reservation, verified collection or confirmed transaction where supported.

A WhatsApp click alone is not a sale and should not automatically trigger commission. The platform should combine a tagged Shoppage session, a consented or structured lead event, duplicate-phone and device checks where lawful, merchant response state and sampling/audit. Off-platform merchant assertions remain lower-confidence evidence unless independently supported. High-risk categories are excluded until specialist policies and review capacity exist.

8.4 Canonical-link and distribution rule

Every paid creator post must use a stable Shoppage Universal Link, not make an external social shop or page the only destination. Links must survive copying between Facebook, WhatsApp, SMS and browsers, retain privacy-safe attribution, open the relevant Merchant Site/product/request and degrade gracefully on low-data devices.

8.5 Safeguards

- sponsored and affiliate disclosure;
- merchant approval of promoted objects and terms;
- music, image, customer-consent and content rights;
- anti-self-referral, duplicate-lead and collusion controls;
- review windows before outcome-based payout;
- category restrictions and expert review for high-risk claims;
- creator appeals and merchant dispute handling;
- tax and contractor treatment confirmed before scale;
- follower count, raw views and superficial engagement are never sufficient payout events.

9. Shoppage Markets

Markets turns physical commerce clusters into searchable, measurable and promotable digital operating units.

9.1 Supported market types

- malls and shopping centres;
- formal and informal markets;
- CBD retail clusters;
- industrial and hardware districts;
- trade fairs and temporary events;
- growth points and rural service centres;
- distributor and franchise networks;
- diaspora-oriented supplier collections.

9.2 Market page

A useful market page includes:

- verified operator or governance status;
- location, boundary and navigation;
- current merchant/stall roster;
- categories, products and services;
- opening hours and event dates;
- market clips and offers;
- collection and delivery information;
- complaints and correction path;
- campaign and sponsorship inventory;
- market-level analytics.

9.3 Market evidence

Market-inside-market, building, section, store and stall relationships cannot be inferred from nearby coordinates alone. Operator records, municipal evidence, field verification, address evidence or reviewed polygon relationships are required.

9.4 Market captains

A Market Captain may onboard merchants, maintain rosters, capture media, coordinate campaigns and escalate disputes. The role requires:

- defined authority and territory;
- training and identification;
- audit trails and quality score;
- separation between verification and personal commercial interest;
- anti-bribery and complaint controls;
- compensation tied to accepted work and durable activation, not raw registrations.

10. Merchant sites and Pemosites

10.1 Binding decision

Every merchant receives a Shoppage Merchant Site. Merchants with effective existing websites may keep them and connect them through feeds, APIs, embeds and attribution links. Shoppage should not force unnecessary migration.

10.2 Source-of-truth model

For every field, the integration must define the authoritative system. Examples:

- legal identity may come from verified merchant/regulator evidence;
- product master may be Shoppage-controlled;
- price and stock may be merchant POS-controlled;
- editorial corporate content may be website-controlled;
- trust and response history remain Shoppage-controlled.

No bidirectional sync should launch without conflict rules, timestamps, ownership and recovery procedures.

10.3 Pemosites

Pemosites should initially be a premium product line using the Shoppage core, not a separate operating company. It serves businesses needing more than a commerce storefront:

- corporate and service pages;
- custom brand presentation;
- news, resources and careers;
- forms, bookings and lead workflows;
- custom domains and email setup;
- managed content, SEO and migration;
- integrations beyond the marketplace.

Pemosites must reuse Shoppage identity, products, branches, offers, analytics and permissions. It must not create a parallel merchant or product database.

10.4 Spinout gate

Consider a separate legal entity only after evidence such as:

- at least 100 paying sites or equivalent contracted recurring revenue;
- repeatable acquisition and onboarding;
- sustainable gross margin after support labour;
- standardised product rather than bespoke agency dependence;
- separate management capacity;
- clear IP, data-processing and cross-selling agreements.

Months 0-3 build the shared Merchant Site engine. Months 4-6 may pilot Pemosites with 10-20 businesses.

11. Commerce Intelligence Graph and Preloaded Launch Inventory

The strongest moat is not the interface. It is a governed, continuously improving evidence graph that connects organisations, branches, places, markets, products, variants, offers, content, demand and outcomes.

11.1 Validated foundation and binding launch expansion

The attached implementation package validates:

- 6,101 organisation-source records and 5,281 distinct normalised names;
- 5,899 ISIC-mapped records;
- exactly 1,000,000 unique global food-product identities;
- 950,334 checksum-valid GTINs and 466,276 family keys;
- 25,210 place/market nodes and 25,209 parent edges;
- 118 explicitly tagged markets or malls;
- a versioned merchant-offer feed contract, idempotent observation store, exact-GTIN matching and review queue.

The binding v1.0 launch expansion is:

- retain and productionise the one-million-plus master reference catalogue;
- add several rights-cleared product, brand, classification, compatibility and attribute sources;
- ingest and resolve at least 10,000 organisation/merchant profiles from authoritative, licensed, purchased, partner and public discovery sources;
- load the national place scaffold and all known public markets available from designated sources;
- create claim-ready Merchant Sites and ownership/correction workflows;
- ingest merchant-authorised offers as soon as feeds, claims or field onboarding arrive;
- deploy a cold-start recommendation engine and local commerce intelligence layer over the graph.

The current package proves the foundation counts stated above. Additional 10,000+ organisation and multi-source product targets become public launch claims only after their source ledgers and validation reports pass. They are not proof that every company is currently trading, every product is sold locally or every market relationship is officially confirmed.

11.2 Stable entities and changing claims

Stable entity	Time-varying claim	Example evidence
Organisation	Currently trading	Merchant, field or transaction evidence
Branch	Operating at a location	Merchant, operator or field verification
Master product	Sold by a merchant	Rights-cleared merchant/distributor feed
Variant	In stock at a branch	Current offer observation
Place/market	Contains a store or stall	Operator, municipal or reviewed field evidence
Creator	Authorised to promote an offer	Campaign contract and merchant approval
Merchant	Responds reliably	Measured lead history
Offer	Price is valid	Timestamped merchant/provider evidence

11.3 Source and provenance requirements

Every production claim should preserve:

- source system, source type and authority;
- predicate scope;
- source identifier and permitted reference;
- observed/retrieved time;
- evidence hash or immutable reference;
- reuse rights and restrictions;
- confidence and verification state;
- reviewer and decision reason;
- validity and supersession history;
- unresolved conflicts.

11.4 Coverage cells

A coverage cell represents a place-category combination. It tracks:

- verified merchants and branches;
- active markets;
- fresh offers and variant depth;
- price and stock recency;
- response rate and verified outcomes;
- buyer demand and unresolved requests;
- trust and complaint signals;
- coverage state: empty, thin, usable, strong or authoritative.

Coverage cells guide field operations, creator tasks, category launches, advertising availability and honest national reporting.

11.5 Intelligence products

Buyer intelligence

- Shoppage Ask and saved needs;
- Price Pulse with date, currency and comparable context;
- Stock Truth with confidence and confirmation time;
- Compatibility Graph for parts, accessories and systems;
- local substitution and alternative suppliers;
- total-outcome comparison including delivery, warranty and trust.

Merchant intelligence

- Business Improvement Copilot;
- demand gaps by area;
- response and conversion diagnostics;
- catalogue completeness and freshness;
- pricing and assortment benchmarks;
- campaign and creator recommendations;
- branch and delivery-zone opportunities.

Market, brand and institutional intelligence

- category demand and stock-out patterns;
- market and cluster performance;
- reseller and distribution visibility;
- price and availability trends;
- merchant digitisation and local-value scorecards;
- privacy-safe aggregated planning data.

Shoppage monetises intelligence, not raw personal data or merchant-confidential records.

11.6 Preloaded intelligence inventory

Shoppage launches with four distinct inventories that must never be conflated:

Inventory	Launch content	Public treatment
Master reference catalogue	1,000,000+ products, identifiers, families, brands, attributes, categories, compatibility and global references	Searchable as reference; local stock and price shown only when a current offer exists
Organisation and merchant graph	10,000+ businesses, organisations, branches and facilities resolved from several sources	Unclaimed or claimed profile with predicate-specific source/freshness labels
Place and market graph	National places, settlements, commercial clusters, markets, buildings, sections, stores and stalls where evidence permits	Searchable geography; containment and operating status carry review states
Historical commerce archive	Time-stamped public, partner, merchant-supplied, purchased and field observations	Used for trend, entity resolution and intelligence; verbatim republication only when rights permit

Every record receives a canonical ID, source ledger, rights class, observation date, confidence, review state, current-state status and correction path. Search and AI may use incomplete records, but the interface must communicate uncertainty.

11.7 Merchant claiming, correction and profile ownership

Every preloaded merchant or company profile should be claimable. The claim workflow must support:

1. phone, email-domain, document, branch, association, field-agent or authorised-partner evidence;
2. organisation/branch resolution before ownership is granted;
3. owner, manager and delegated staff roles;
4. duplicate merge and mistaken-identity review;
5. correction requests from merchants and the public;
6. appeals when a claim is rejected or challenged;
7. audit history for every field changed after claim;
8. export of merchant-managed data and revocation of staff access.

A merchant claim gives authority over current trading fields, catalogue and offers. It does not permit deletion of lawful regulator records, historical evidence, complaints, source provenance or other parties' rights. Unclaimed profiles must be clearly labelled and must never create the impression that Shoppage represents the business.

11.8 Historical Commerce Archive

Shoppage may build historical intelligence from:

- merchant-supplied Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp and website exports;
- public Facebook group listings and posts where collection and reuse are legally and contractually permitted;
- collaborating websites and platforms under data-sharing agreements;
- purchased directories with explicit warranties, permitted uses, update rights and deletion obligations;
- public regulator, association, mall, market and directory records;
- field observations, price tags, catalogues, receipts and campaign outcomes under contributor terms;
- merchant, distributor, manufacturer, POS and ecommerce feeds.

Public availability is not by itself a licence for unrestricted scraping, republication or AI training. The acquisition pipeline must record collection method, platform terms, robots controls where relevant, licence, attribution,

personal-data basis, media rights, retention and takedown requirements. Private groups, private messages, minors' data, sensitive personal information and unrelated social interactions are excluded unless a specific lawful and consented workflow exists.

The archive should prefer structured extracted claims and references over copying entire posts. Historical price, product, location and availability facts may feed trend models when lawful; copyrighted text, images and video require separate rights. Source removals and corrections must propagate through derived current-state views and future training corpora.

11.9 AI recommendation and local commerce model

A production recommendation engine is a launch requirement, but it begins with cold-start intelligence rather than pretending to have mature collaborative behaviour.

Launch recommendation signals

- query and explicit buyer intent;
- category, brand, attributes, variant and compatibility;
- distance, delivery area, open-now state and collection feasibility;
- current local offer freshness, price currency and stock confidence;
- merchant verification, response and complaint state;
- product quality/completeness and content usefulness;
- saved needs, exclusions and user-controlled preferences;
- seasonality, market context and diaspora/local purchasing mode;
- transparent sponsored eligibility after organic relevance floors.

Recommendation surfaces

- products and variants for buyers;
- alternative local suppliers when an item is unavailable;
- compatible products and services;
- merchants to receive buyer requests;
- content and creator recommendations;
- products, prices, areas and campaigns merchants should improve;
- markets and commercial clusters relevant to a need.

Shoppage Local Commerce Intelligence Model

Shoppage should build a local model stack, not attempt to train a frontier foundation model from scratch during launch. The stack comprises:

- Zimbabwean commerce taxonomy, entities, aliases and local-language synonym layers;
- multilingual embeddings and semantic retrieval;
- entity-resolution and duplicate-detection models;
- learning-to-rank and recommendation models;
- compatibility and substitution models;
- demand, price, stock and fulfilment forecasting;
- fraud, moderation and data-quality models;
- retrieval-augmented merchant and buyer copilots;
- later rights-cleared fine-tuning where evaluation proves value.

All training, fine-tuning and evaluation datasets require a corpus manifest, rights class, provenance, removal path and leakage tests. Model outputs are claims or recommendations, never evidence by themselves.

11.10 No-empty-platform launch rule

The following must be true before public launch:

- master-product search returns meaningful reference results even before a local offer exists;
- organisation, place and market search has national breadth from designated sources;
- every reference result clearly separates “known globally”, “observed in Zimbabwe”, “available from this branch” and “confirmed now”;
- unclaimed merchants can be claimed or corrected without staff intervention in ordinary cases;
- buyer requests create demand where local offer coverage is thin;
- recommendations degrade gracefully when behavioural data is sparse;
- source, rights and correction controls are operational;
- the system does not manufacture stock, prices, operating status or ownership from inference.

12. Defensibility and network effects

A competitor can copy a storefront or video feed. It cannot reproduce the following assets overnight:

1. **Preloaded and verified commerce graph:** one-million-plus masters, claim-ready organisations, national places, markets, time-stamped claims, sources, conflicts and correction history.
2. **Fresh local offer network:** branch-level price, stock, service and fulfilment observations.
3. **Merchant operating workflow:** daily actions, staff permissions, lead history and improvement data.
4. **Trust and outcome history:** verification, response, complaint and fulfilment performance.
5. **Geo and market relationships:** operators, captains, stalls, clusters, routes and coverage cells.
6. **Creator attribution graph:** content rights, tagged objects, campaigns and verified outcomes.
7. **Buyer demand graph:** searches, saved needs, requests, recommendation responses and unmet local demand.
8. **Advertising performance graph:** local creative, location, product and outcome intelligence.
9. **Framework ecosystem:** integrations and subsidiaries that reuse and improve the same core.
10. **Historical Commerce Archive:** multi-source observations and trend history that are expensive to acquire, clean, license and maintain.
11. **Merchant claim network:** ownership, corrections, branches, staff authority and continuing first-party refresh.
12. **Local model advantage:** Zimbabwe-specific entities, language, compatibility, demand and ranking evaluation built on rights-cleared data.

12.1 Compounding loops

Supply loop

More activated merchants -> more useful offers -> better buyer resolution -> more leads -> stronger merchant retention -> more first-party data.

Demand loop

More buyer searches and requests -> better demand insight -> targeted merchant acquisition -> deeper coverage -> more resolved searches.

Trust loop

More verified outcomes -> stronger reputation -> higher conversion -> more measurable outcomes -> better risk models.

Creator loop

More attributable products -> better creator earnings -> more useful content -> more discovery -> more merchant participation.

Framework loop

More approved extensions -> more reuse and observations -> stronger core graph -> lower marginal cost for new businesses -> more extension demand.

12.2 Copy-resistance rules

- Never reduce the graph to a scrapeable public directory.
- Keep public APIs scoped and rights-cleared.
- Preserve evidence and change history internally.
- Give merchants export rights without exposing other merchants' confidential data.
- Use contracts, rate limits, anomaly detection and canary fields against bulk extraction.

- Do not claim proprietary ownership over third-party data beyond legal rights.
- Make service quality, field relationships and operational learning as important as code.

13. Daily utility and responsible habit formation

The product should become a daily habit because it resolves real tasks, not because it manipulates attention.

13.1 Buyer return reasons

- stock and price alerts;
- saved needs and matched requests;
- nearby availability and open-now updates;
- trusted deal and new-stock feeds;
- creator buying guides;
- repeat household or business lists;
- service reminders, compatibility and replacement needs;
- market events and local commercial news.

13.2 Merchant return reasons

- stale stock and price actions;
- new leads and response queues;
- campaign and creator results;
- product-demand signals;
- unresolved buyer requests;
- trust, complaint and fulfilment actions;
- daily Business Improvement Copilot recommendations;
- branch and market performance.

13.3 Responsible engagement

Shoppage should not use infinite-scroll coercion, deceptive notifications, fake scarcity, hidden sponsorships, unreadable cancellation or fabricated social proof. Notification frequency must be controllable. Video feeds should have natural stopping points and data controls.

13.4 High-value product systems

Priority systems include:

- Shoppage Ask / Request Network;
- Price Pulse;
- Stock Truth;
- Compatibility Graph;
- Merchant Reputation Passport;
- Verified Collection Network;
- Universal Merchant Link and QR;
- WhatsApp and voice ingestion;
- Diaspora Purchase Concierge;
- B2B Procurement Exchange;
- Made in Zimbabwe Discovery;
- Proof-backed reviews;
- Commerce Academy;
- Business Improvement Score;
- Community Correction Network;
- Commerce Continuity View.

These are sequenced by evidence and roadmap gates, not launched simultaneously.

14. AI-native operating model

AI is a productivity, quality and intelligence layer. It is not permission to publish unverified claims or generate fragile software.

14.1 Launch AI capabilities

Merchant operations

- extract draft products from images, PDFs, spreadsheets and messages;
- clean titles and descriptions;
- suggest categories, attributes and variants;
- identify duplicate products and offers;
- generate captions, cards and price overlays;
- prioritise stale or incomplete records;
- assist support and onboarding agents.

Buyers and discovery

- interpret natural-language and voice requests;
- expand local synonyms and brand nicknames;
- match requests to qualified merchants;
- recommend compatible or locally available alternatives;
- produce cold-start recommendations from the preloaded graph before behavioural scale exists;
- distinguish global reference matches from current Zimbabwe offers;
- summarise differences with uncertainty shown.

Trust and operations

- detect suspicious pricing, duplicate scam images and anomalous behaviour;
- prioritise moderation and resolution queues;
- identify data-quality regressions;
- draft, but not decide, high-impact cases.

14.2 AI data and model architecture

The AI layer must use the Commerce Intelligence Graph as a governed retrieval and feature system. Product text, social history, purchased directories, partner data and merchant feeds enter separate provenance partitions. Training and retrieval access is granted by rights class rather than by technical availability.

The model stack should use provider-independent adapters, an internal model registry, reproducible evaluation sets, shadow tests and fallbacks. High-volume tasks such as classification, extraction and embeddings should use the cheapest model that meets measured quality. Sensitive or rights-restricted data should not be sent to third-party models without an approved processing basis and contract.

Core launch evaluations include entity-resolution precision, category/attribute extraction, multilingual query recall, recommendation relevance, geographic validity, offer freshness, hallucination rate, bias across merchant size/location and human-review workload.

14.3 Human decision boundaries

Human approval and appeal are required for:

- identity-verification rejection;
- serious fraud labels;

- account suspension or permanent removal;
- disputed payment or fulfilment liability;
- high-impact entity merges;
- unsafe-category publication;
- material public or government reporting.

14.4 AI evaluation

Each production model requires:

- defined task and permitted inputs;
- Zimbabwe-specific evaluation set;
- baseline and acceptance threshold;
- error taxonomy by language, category and user group;
- privacy and security review;
- cost and latency budget;
- fallback when unavailable;
- monitoring for drift and abuse;
- rollback path and owner.

14.5 AI-assisted development controls

- modular architecture and typed contracts;
- tests written with or before generated code;
- human review for authentication, payments, permissions and data migrations;
- dependency and licence scanning;
- no secrets in prompts or repositories;
- architecture decision records;
- staging, feature flags and rollback;
- production observability from the first release.

15. Trust, safety and consumer protection

Trust is a product system, not a badge.

15.1 Progressive verification

Verification levels may include:

- phone and email;
- authorised representative;
- identity;
- physical location;
- legal business identity;
- regulated licence or professional credential;
- bank/payment destination;
- brand or authorised-dealer status;
- market or operator membership.

Badges must state exactly what was checked and when. “Verified” cannot imply guarantees beyond the verification scope.

15.2 Reputation

Merchant reputation should combine:

- time on platform;
- last active and freshness behaviour;
- response rate and time;
- accepted/declined request history;
- verified collection or fulfilment outcomes;
- complaint severity and resolution;
- policy and warranty adherence;
- data accuracy corrections.

15.3 Proof-backed reviews

Reviews should be weighted by evidence such as verified contact, quote, reservation, payment, collection or fulfilment. Unverified comments may be displayed separately or used as reports, not treated as equal transactional proof.

15.4 Category safety

High-risk categories require stricter controls or exclusion. Policies must cover counterfeit goods, unsafe products, regulated goods, prohibited services, misleading health/financial claims, age-restricted goods, stolen goods and intellectual-property complaints.

15.5 Disputes and complaints

The system needs:

- clear report types;
- evidence upload;
- response deadlines;
- merchant and creator appeal;

- neutral review ownership;
- severity-based escalation;
- outcome and remediation history;
- regulatory or law-enforcement referral protocol where legally required.

16. Payments and transaction ownership

16.1 Binding decision

Shoppage owns the commercial workflow and evidence record. Licensed providers process and settle money. The vendor remains the seller and merchant of record for ordinary vendor sales unless a later, explicitly contracted model states otherwise.

Shoppage will not initially:

- hold customer funds;
- pool merchant settlements;
- operate a deposit wallet;
- store card numbers, CVVs or mobile-money PINs;
- promise escrow without a licensed structure;
- become merchant of record by default.

Zimbabwe already has domestic online-payment infrastructure, including Zimswitch Online and Paynow merchant/e-commerce services.[4][5]

16.2 Payment methods

- cash on collection;
- cash on delivery where a merchant/partner supports it;
- mobile money;
- bank transfer or ZIPIT-style transfer;
- provider-hosted card or online checkout;
- payment link;
- deposit or reservation payment;
- later buyer-protection or escrow-like products through licensed partners.

16.3 Shoppage responsibilities

- display accepted methods and conditions;
- initiate provider payment;
- create order/reservation reference;
- receive signed status callbacks;
- reconcile status and exception records;
- issue Shoppage transaction evidence and merchant receipt links;
- preserve dispute and refund evidence;
- calculate platform fees where contracted;
- prevent ads or content from falsely implying payment protection.

16.4 Provider-adapter standard

Every adapter must support idempotency, signed webhooks, replay protection, timeout handling, reconciliation, refund/status mapping, sandbox testing, incident ownership and provider exit procedures.

16.5 Ad credits

Shoppage may sell prepaid promotional credits for platform advertising, provided they are clearly limited-purpose, non-withdrawable and accounted for as service credits. They must not be marketed or operated as a general stored-value wallet.

17. Fulfilment and last-mile delivery

17.1 Binding decision

Physical fulfilment is partner-led and merchant-led, but it cannot be invisible or completely off-platform. Shoppage orchestrates options, quotes, statuses and evidence without initially owning a national fleet or warehouse network.

17.2 Supported modes

- buyer collection from branch or stall;
- verified collection point;
- merchant delivery;
- courier or delivery partner;
- installer or technician fulfilment;
- long-distance bus/courier route;
- buyer-arranged bulk haulage;
- scheduled market or event pickup.

17.3 Shoppage responsibilities

- collect dimensions, weight, category and handling constraints where relevant;
- show service area and delivery assumptions;
- request and compare quotes;
- capture selected provider and reference;
- display dispatch, pickup and delivery states;
- collect proof of collection, delivery or installation;
- record failed attempts, cancellations and complaints;
- maintain merchant/partner performance histories;
- separate delivery fee, platform fee and merchant price.

17.4 Category-specific fulfilment

Category	Appropriate launch approach	Later depth
Small parcels/electronics	Standard rates, tracking and proof	Automated partner selection
Building materials	Quote, vehicle type, distance and offloading	Route/haulage marketplace
Solar/installations	Product plus technician scheduling	Certification and job milestones
Furniture/appliances	Scheduled delivery and condition proof	Reverse logistics and installation
Informal markets	Verified collection desk or captain coordination	Shared market fulfilment hub

17.5 Asset-ownership gate

Owned vehicles, warehouses or dark stores require a specific zone/category business case with sustained density, positive fully loaded economics, unacceptable partner failure and dedicated operational leadership. They are not default strategic ambitions.

18. Data governance, rights and compliance

18.1 Data protection

POTRAZ is the Data Protection Authority and publishes the Cyber and Data Protection Act and implementation guidance.[6] Shoppage must obtain Zimbabwe legal advice on data-controller registration/licensing, data-protection officer requirements, cross-border processing, cookies, direct marketing, children, biometric data and breach notification before public scale.

Core controls:

- purpose limitation and data minimisation;
- transparent privacy notices;
- role-based access and least privilege;
- consent where required;
- data-subject access, correction and deletion workflows;
- retention schedules;
- cross-border processor register;
- encryption in transit and at rest;
- incident response and breach records;
- vendor and plugin data-processing agreements.

18.2 Rights and licensing

Every data source requires an inventory of ownership, licence, permitted use, attribution, share-alike implications, personal-data basis, AI-training permission, refresh method, correction route, termination risk and required deletion propagation.

Purchased directories and collaboration feeds require contractual warranties covering provenance, collection authority, permitted commercial display, derivative analytics, AI use, update cadence, security, correction, takedown and indemnity. “Bought” does not automatically mean rights-cleared.

Public social history requires a separate collection policy. Approved methods are platform-authorized APIs, merchant/user-provided exports, partner agreements, manual or field observations permitted by law, and other methods cleared against platform terms and data-protection obligations. Public visibility alone does not authorise unrestricted automated collection.

The one-million-product Open Food Facts-derived reference requires explicit ODbL/database-content review before public combination, redistribution or commercial derivative use. Shoppage should keep source-derived and merchant-proprietary data separable where legally and technically necessary.

18.3 Merchant and buyer data

- merchants own their original content subject to the licence granted to operate Shoppage;
- merchants can export their own catalogue and transactions;
- Shoppage owns platform-generated models, aggregate analytics and system records subject to law and contracts;
- one merchant’s confidential performance cannot be exposed to another;
- personal data is not sold;
- aggregate intelligence uses minimum cohort sizes and suppression controls;
- partner access is purpose-limited, logged and revocable.

18.4 Consumer and advertising compliance

Before launch, counsel should review:

- Consumer Protection Act requirements;
- pricing and discount disclosures;
- electronic contracting and records;
- platform/vendor liability statements;
- returns, warranties and refund terms;
- creator and sponsored-content disclosure;
- prohibited and regulated goods;
- courier and postal licensing implications;
- tax invoices, commissions and creator payments;
- terms for market captains and field agents.

19. Revenue model and pricing architecture

Shoppage needs multiple revenue streams, but each must reinforce platform utility rather than tax immature demand.

19.1 Revenue hierarchy

Revenue stream	Timing	Economic character
Assisted onboarding and catalogue services	Launch	Early cash, labour-intensive
Managed campaigns and content production	Launch	Early revenue and learning
Sponsored products/sites/clips/markets	Launch with demand limits	Scalable media revenue
Merchant subscriptions	Launch and expansion	Recurring software revenue
Qualified request/lead products	Launch in selected categories	High-value performance revenue
Creator campaign administration	Launch/expansion	Service and platform fee
Pemosites and premium Merchant Sites	Months 4-6	Recurring plus setup revenue
Intelligence products	Launch internally; Months 4-6 external products	High-margin, rights-sensitive and evidence-dependent
Framework/API/plugin fees	Private beta then later	Platform revenue
Payment/fulfilment orchestration fees	Later where contractually justified	Transaction-linked
Native transaction commission	Later	Requires strong trust and operations

19.2 Pricing hypotheses

Prices are interview and pilot hypotheses, not fixed commitments.

- Free: limited catalogue, Merchant Site, contact actions and basic analytics.
- Starter: approximately US\$5-10 per month for larger catalogue, freshness tools and basic promotions.
- Growth: approximately US\$15-30 per month for staff, leads, clips, campaigns and improved analytics.
- Pro/multi-branch: approximately US\$50+ per month depending on branches, integrations and support.
- Enterprise/market/brand: contracted pricing.
- Self-service ads: low entry packages from approximately US\$5, subject to useful audience volume.
- Managed campaign/content/onboarding: scoped service pricing.

Pricing must be tested against merchant gross profit and attributable value, not copied from South African or global SaaS benchmarks.

19.3 Unit-economics discipline

Track separately:

- software gross margin;
- managed-service gross margin;
- creator payouts and media cost;
- field activation cost;
- support cost by merchant tier;
- payment and fulfilment pass-through;
- infrastructure cost per active merchant, search and video minute;
- customer acquisition cost and payback;
- revenue concentration.

Do not hide labour-intensive onboarding inside “software” margin.

20. Competitive strategy and platform substitution

20.1 Current alternatives

Zimbabwean buyers and merchants already use Facebook Marketplace, Facebook pages/groups, WhatsApp, Google Search/Maps, Classifieds.co.zw and marketplace sites such as Ownai, ShopAtZim and Hypermarket. Current public sites show that Classifieds offers broad category listings and free ads, Ownai offers a multi-category cart and comparison experience, and Hypermarket positions around multi-vendor products, verified sellers and Paynow checkout.[7][8][9]

Shoppage must not claim competitors have no value. It wins by solving a different combination of problems better.

20.2 Outclass strategy

Existing channel strength	Structural gap	Shoppage advantage to build
Facebook reach and communities	Weak structured catalogue, freshness and attribution	Merchant truth, product graph and measurable actions
WhatsApp conversion and relationships	Poor discovery, comparison and analytics	Searchable catalogue and structured handoff
Google broad search and maps	Limited branch-level local stock and trust history	Local offer, freshness, market and response intelligence
Classifieds breadth	Listing-centric, limited merchant operating system	Recurring merchant workflow and evidence graph
Marketplace checkout	Transaction-focused but limited media/intelligence depth	Search, video, ads, creators, markets and platform framework
TikTok/Reels entertainment	Attention not necessarily linked to current local offer	Every clip linked to merchant/product/market and action

20.3 Google Shopping substitution

Shoppage should aim to resolve Zimbabwe-specific shopping questions with information generic search often lacks:

- exact variant and compatibility;
- current branch availability;
- local price date and currency;
- merchant response and verification history;
- collection and delivery feasibility;
- market/stall context;
- local alternatives and requests.

The objective is category-by-category commercial search leadership, not replacing general web search.

20.4 Google/Meta advertising substitution

Merchant budget shifts only if Shoppage demonstrates better cost per qualified local action. Shoppage should baseline external ad spend for participating merchants, run controlled campaigns, report comparable outcomes and calculate wallet-share movement.

External platforms remain optional acquisition channels during the transition. Cards, clips and links should be optimised for Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok and Google while merchant identity, canonical content, requests, leads and outcome data remain on Shoppage. No external channel may become a critical-path dependency or the only measurable source of buyer demand.

20.5 Social-platform independence strategy

Shoppage should win with external platforms where they provide reach, but survive without them. Acquisition may include user-initiated Facebook/WhatsApp sharing, permitted feeds, creator distribution and public-search indexing. The product must continue to acquire and retain users through Merchant Sites, QR infrastructure, saved needs, price/stock alerts, the Request Network, market pages, direct notifications and referrals based on resolved needs.

Management should review **Owned Demand Share** and **External Platform Concentration** monthly. A rising share of direct, saved, QR, request and notification-originated sessions is evidence that Shoppage is becoming a platform rather than a social-selling utility.

20.6 Competitive-response system

- monthly competitor capability review;
- quarterly merchant and buyer interviews;
- public feature/request intake;
- two-week delivery cycles for measurable improvements;
- feature flags and experiments;
- “adopt, adapt or reject” decision log;
- no feature matching without a clear user or economic outcome.

21. Shoppage Framework and ecosystem

21.1 Framework decision

Shoppage is both a product family and a reusable commerce framework. The framework allows approved subsidiaries, partners and independent businesses to build specialised applications without recreating identity, product, place, trust, payment, fulfilment and intelligence systems.

21.2 Commerce kernel

The kernel provides:

- identity, organisations, roles and consent;
- place, market and branch graph;
- catalogue, variants and offers;
- search, recommendations and saved needs;
- trust, verification and disputes;
- leads, RFQs, reservations and orders;
- advertising, content and creator attribution;
- payment and fulfilment orchestration;
- billing and entitlements;
- analytics, evidence and AI services.

21.3 Extension types

Extension type	Example	Governance
First-party module	Price Pulse or Merchant CRM	Core roadmap and shared P&L
First-party vertical	Construction procurement	Dedicated product owner, shared kernel
Product line	Pemosites	Shared data and internal cost centre
Subsidiary	Proven specialised business	Admission gates and licence agreement
Certified plugin	POS, ERP, payment or fulfilment adapter	Review, scopes, support and certification
Powered application	Independent market or distributor portal	API contract, consent and usage billing
White-label deployment	Association or institutional commerce portal	No database fork; central identity and evidence rules

21.4 Platform rules

- no direct third-party database access;
- scoped credentials and least privilege;
- signed webhooks and idempotent writes;
- merchant consent for plugin access;
- versioned APIs and deprecation policy;
- audit of every partner action;
- data export and termination procedure;
- certification and reliability score;
- no arbitrary third-party code inside core production processes;
- no public app store in months 0-6.

21.5 Subsidiary admission gate

A candidate becomes a subsidiary only when it has:

- distinct customer and value proposition;
- evidence of demand and repeat usage;
- identifiable revenue and cost structure;
- dedicated accountable leader;
- compliance and risk assessment;
- strategic reason not to remain a module;
- platform licence and data-sharing agreement;
- board-approved capital plan.

21.6 Ecosystem economics

Possible framework revenue includes API usage, plugin certification, revenue share, platform licence, white-label subscription, managed integration, premium support and intelligence access. These should begin after core reliability and merchant consent are proven.

22. Go-to-market and field operations

22.1 Supply-first launch

The first problem is useful supply, not app downloads. Shoppage should recruit a curated merchant cohort and digitise enough fresh products to resolve real buyer needs.

Merchant acquisition channels:

- direct field sales in commercial clusters;
- distributors and brands introducing stockists;
- market and mall operator partnerships;
- trade associations and specialist communities;
- creator-led merchant onboarding;
- referrals from payment, POS, bank and telecom partners;
- diaspora-oriented merchant packages;
- managed catalogue and content days.

22.2 Merchant activation standard

A merchant counts as activated only when:

- authorised representative is established;
- branch/location and contact path are usable;
- minimum catalogue quality is met;
- freshness obligations are accepted;
- at least one buyer action can be completed;
- response workflow is demonstrated;
- policies and payment/fulfilment methods are stated;
- staff know how to maintain the account.

22.3 Buyer acquisition

Buyer acquisition is organised in three tiers so that social reach accelerates Shoppage without becoming its oxygen.

Owned and physical distribution

- QR codes at shops, stalls, markets, receipts, quotations, packaging and collection points;
- memorable Merchant Site and market links;
- Request Network flyers and category-specific buyer guides;
- saved needs, stock/price alerts and consented push, SMS or email notifications;
- market events, merchant referrals and repeat-use loops based on resolved needs.

Partner distribution

- market and mall operators;
- creators and community operators;
- distributors, brands, installers, payment and fulfilment partners;
- trade associations, campuses and specialist communities.

External-platform acquisition

- user-initiated Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok and other sharing;
- permitted platform feeds or publishing adapters where commercially and legally justified;
- public-search indexing of Merchant Sites, market pages and buying guides;

- paid external acquisition only when its economics are measured against direct Shoppage alternatives.

The growth dashboard must separate direct/owned, partner and external-platform demand. SEO is useful but is not the demand strategy by itself.

22.4 Field network

Field agents and Market Captains need a controlled work system:

- assigned territory and task;
- source/evidence capture;
- duplicate detection;
- quality review;
- accepted-work payment;
- merchant consent;
- code of conduct;
- complaint and fraud process;
- productivity and retention metrics.

22.5 1,000-entity programme

The 1,000-entity programme should build a traceable, reviewed commerce register, not produce a marketing number. It should include merchants, branches, markets, creators, distributors, service providers, fulfilment partners and institutions relevant to launch categories. Each record needs source, predicate, date, verification state and owner.

23. International quality and technical architecture

23.1 Quality standard

Global quality means the core experience is fast, reliable, accessible, secure and understandable on common Zimbabwean devices and networks.

Initial service targets:

Quality area	Controlled-launch target	Expansion target
Availability	99.5% monthly for core buyer/merchant flows	99.9% after operational maturity
Web performance	p75 LCP below 2.5s on representative 4G tests	Continuous device/network monitoring
Search latency	p95 below 500ms for common queries	Category-specific relevance SLAs
Crash-free sessions	At least 99.5%	At least 99.8%
Accessibility	Core flows audited toward WCAG 2.2 AA	Full design-system compliance
Data freshness	Category-specific visible SLA	Automated partner/merchant health
Security	No known critical production vulnerabilities	Continuous scanning and formal testing
Support	Severity and customer-class response targets	7-day operational coverage where justified
Offline resilience	Cached sites/items and safely queued drafts after install	Selective local indexes where justified

Targets require measurement; they are not guarantees before instrumentation is live.

23.2 Technical architecture

Recommended controlled-launch stack:

- Next.js App Router PWA for buyer and simplified merchant experiences;
- Refine or equivalent for dense internal/enterprise administration;
- NestJS modular monolith as authoritative business layer;
- Prisma and PostgreSQL/Supabase-managed infrastructure;
- Meilisearch for catalogue and geo-faceted search across one-million-plus masters, organisations, markets and local offers, benchmarked against actual data;
- BullMQ/Redis for imports, indexing, notifications, media and AI jobs;
- managed object storage and a dedicated short-video service;
- vector/embedding and model-feature stores implemented conservatively within PostgreSQL/pgvector or a justified managed service;
- model registry, evaluation harness, corpus manifests and rights-aware retrieval controls;
- structured logs, metrics, traces, error tracking and security monitoring;
- pnpm/Turborepo monorepo and shared contracts;
- optional channel-adaptor layer for social sharing, public feeds and external identities, isolated from critical core services.

23.3 Portability

Provider and channel choices must be adapter-based. The platform needs documented export and migration paths for database, object storage, search, video, messaging, AI, payments, hosting and external distribution channels. Supabase, Vercel, Railway, Cloudflare Stream or Mux may be pragmatic providers, but no provider should become an unexamined strategic dependency.

23.4 Production data architecture

The supplied SQLite assets are for reproducible validation and scale testing. Production requires PostgreSQL multi-tenancy, evidence/history tables, materialised current-state views, review queues, search indexes, access controls, backups and migration testing.

23.5 Security baseline

- MFA for platform administrators and high-risk merchant roles;
- row-level and service-layer tenant isolation;
- least-privilege service accounts;
- secrets manager and key rotation;
- signed uploads and malware scanning;
- secure webhook validation;
- dependency and container scanning;
- audit logs for data, permissions, payments and moderation;
- tested backup restore;
- incident response and breach drills;
- penetration testing before material payment/transaction scale.

24. Months 0-3 controlled launch roadmap

AI-assisted development can shorten implementation, but field operations, merchant activation, rights, moderation and adoption remain critical-path work. The plan uses four parallel workstreams: product/engineering, commerce data, field/go-to-market and governance/operations.

24.1 Weeks 1-2: scope, kernel and launch cohort

Product and engineering

- lock domain model, permissions, evidence states and event taxonomy;
- create monorepo, CI/CD, environments, auth and tenant isolation;
- implement organisations, branches, places, products, variants and offers;
- establish observability and feature flags;
- define canonical IDs, external-identity mappings, channel-adaptor contracts and independence test cases.

Commerce data

- import and validate the one-million-plus master-product foundation into production-ready search partitions;
- ingest, deduplicate and source-label the 10,000+ organisation/profile launch inventory;
- load the national place scaffold and known market inventory from designated sources;
- create launch-wedge product/attribute/compatibility taxonomy;
- prepare merchant feed and manual/CSV ingestion;
- define freshness and verification policies.

Field and commercial

- recruit first 20-30 anchor merchants;
- select 3-5 clusters/markets;
- establish merchant interview and pricing programme;
- identify payment, fulfilment and creator pilot partners.

Governance

- legal/privacy/payment/consumer review;
- prohibited categories and content policy;
- merchant, creator and partner agreements;
- incident and complaints ownership.

24.2 Weeks 3-4: Merchant Sites and offer truth

- launch merchant claim, ownership-resolution, correction, duplicate-merge and onboarding flow;
- launch Merchant Site templates;
- product-reference attachment, local master/variant creation, branch and offer management;
- image/CSV assisted ingestion;
- price, stock, evidence and freshness states;
- canonical Universal Links, QR assets and user-initiated social sharing;
- offline-cached Merchant Site shell and queued merchant drafts;
- internal review queues;
- field capture app/workflow;
- first 500-1,000 usable offers.

24.3 Weeks 5-6: buyer discovery and requests

- keyword, semantic, filter and location search across masters, organisations, markets and local offers;

- product, Merchant Site and market pages;
- manual location and nearby discovery;
- Ask/Request flow and merchant routing;
- WhatsApp/call/quote attribution;
- save/share and basic alerts;
- freshness, operational-proximity and Request Network acceptance tests as the native demand wedge;
- trust and report controls;
- cold-start product, merchant and request recommendation alpha;
- first controlled buyer tests.

24.4 Weeks 7-8: Showcase, creators and markets

- catalogue-linked short-video upload and playback;
- captions, rights and moderation;
- creator applications, fixed-bounty contracts, canonical-link rules and deliverable verification;
- tagged-link measurement without launch-stage performance commissions;
- market pages, rosters, maps and captains;
- content and market campaign analytics;
- low-data and data-saver modes.

24.5 Weeks 9-10: Ads, payment and fulfilment orchestration

- fixed-package sponsored products, sites and clips;
- managed campaign workflow;
- ad eligibility, labels, spend caps and reports;
- provider-hosted payment initiation and callbacks;
- collection, merchant delivery and partner quote options;
- proof/status and dispute evidence;
- Pemosites shared-engine prototype.

24.6 Weeks 11-12: hardening and controlled launch

- load, security, accessibility and recovery tests;
- search relevance, source-state display, recommendation and AI evaluation;
- content, trust and payment/fulfilment drills;
- merchant training and support playbooks;
- analytics and executive scorecard;
- pilot campaign and fixed creator-bounty payouts;
- social-adaptor kill-switch and external-platform outage drill;
- public launch to bounded geography/category;
- day-30 improvement backlog.

24.7 Month-three release gates

- no critical security defects;
- tested backup and rollback;
- 1,000,000+ master products indexed with source/licence partitions;
- 10,000+ organisation/merchant profiles loaded with claim and correction paths;
- national place scaffold and known-market inventory queryable;
- 50+ activated merchants or a justified revised threshold;
- at least 3,000 fresh local offers or sufficient category coverage;
- stable search-to-contact flow;
- merchant response and complaint process working;
- ads clearly labelled and attributable;
- payment/fulfilment provider responsibilities documented;

- privacy, terms and consumer policies published;
- operating team can resolve incidents without developers improvising every case;
- core login, claim, correct, publish, search, recommend, request, lead and maintenance flows pass with all social adapters disabled;
- creator bounty verification, rights and dispute processes are operational.

24.8 Explicit exclusions

- national fleet or warehouse;
- Shoppage wallet or fund custody;
- every category and province;
- public plugin marketplace;
- unrestricted public APIs;
- fully automated verification decisions;
- mature loyalty, escrow, refunds and returns engine;
- native mobile apps unless PWA evidence proves insufficient;
- manual perfection of every one-million-plus reference product before launch; enrichment is automated and prioritised by demand, risk and local relevance;
- unauthorised scraping or automated publishing that violates external-platform rules;
- performance-based creator commissions before attribution, deduplication and dispute gates pass;
- full offline search, live stock or payment-status claims when the device is disconnected.

25. Months 4-6 expansion roadmap

Expansion is conditional on launch evidence, not calendar alone.

25.1 Entry gates

- repeat buyer use in covered categories;
- merchant response and freshness above target;
- measurable campaign outcomes;
- support and moderation capacity;
- payment and fulfilment incident rate within limits;
- positive unit-economics trajectory for at least one revenue stream;
- reliable evidence and rights controls;
- creator link attribution, deduplication, dispute and payout reconciliation pass before outcome commissions are enabled.

25.2 Expansion priorities

- deepen Harare local-offer truth while maintaining national reference discovery;
- increase merchant profile claim, correction and verified-current-operation rates;
- tune the local recommendation/ranking models using measured outcomes and explicit feedback;
- replicate to Bulawayo or the next strongest evidence-based city;
- add selected electronics/auto/agriculture/service verticals only after taxonomy and partner readiness;
- expand creator marketplace and market sponsorships;
- introduce verified lead commissions only for approved categories and creators after the Tier 2 release gate;
- pilot Pemosites with 10-20 businesses;
- introduce self-service ads to proven merchant cohorts;
- launch saved needs, Price Pulse and deeper compatibility;
- add more payment and fulfilment adapters;
- private developer portal and TypeScript SDK;
- three to five certified integrations;
- one powered market, distributor or procurement application;
- privacy-safe aggregate intelligence pilots;
- diaspora purchase and proof-of-fulfilment pilot;
- formal evaluation of one vertical as a product line or subsidiary.

25.3 Expansion rule

A new city or category receives investment only when it has:

- merchant anchors;
- field/partner owner;
- product taxonomy and safety policy;
- sufficient buyer demand or requests;
- payment/fulfilment feasibility;
- support capacity;
- measurable coverage-cell plan;
- budget and stop criteria.

26. Metrics, economics and investor proof

26.1 North-star metric

Resolved Local Commerce Needs: buyer needs that reach a credible outcome through a fresh, attributable Shoppage path.

A resolved need may be a verified merchant contact, accepted quote, reservation, collection, fulfilment or transaction, with confidence levels kept separate.

26.2 Core metric tree

Domain	Core metrics	Guardrails
Supply	Activated merchants, fresh offers, variant depth, coverage cells	Accuracy, rights and merchant retention
Demand	Searches, recommendations, requests, repeat users, resolved needs, owned-demand share	Failed-search, irrelevant recommendations, complaint and external-platform concentration
Conversion	Search-to-product, product-to-contact, response, quote acceptance	Duplicate/fake leads
Ads	Spend, cost per qualified action, wallet share, repeat advertisers	Organic relevance and complaint rate
Creators	Accepted bounties, useful content, tagged-link learning; later attributable outcomes	Rights, fraud, disclosure, duplicate leads and payout disputes
Markets	Active merchants, roster freshness, market traffic/actions	Operator disputes and stale rosters
Operations	Review backlog, support time, freshness SLA, incidents	Staff workload and quality
Economics	Revenue, gross margin, CAC, payback, retention, concentration	Service labour and imported costs

26.3 Investor proof milestones

By month 3

- controlled product works end to end with social adapters disabled;
- curated supply and buyer actions exist;
- foundation-to-production data path is operational;
- at least one paid revenue stream has real customers;
- no material compliance or security blocker;
- roadmap is evidence-driven.

By month 6

- repeat merchant and buyer behaviour with increasing owned/direct demand share;
- multiple revenue streams with separated margins;
- advertising outcome evidence;
- category/city replication playbook;
- platform reuse through Pemosites or one powered application;
- improving coverage and data quality;
- credible capital plan for the next 12-18 months.

26.4 Investor safeguards

- do not count reference records as active inventory;
- do not count merchant registrations as activated supply;
- separate GMV, leads and verified sales;
- disclose related-party and partner concentration;
- separate software and service margins;
- maintain board-visible data-rights and security incidents;
- gate subsidiaries and capital allocation;
- track imported infrastructure exposure;
- preserve PlatformCo IP and data-contract ownership.

27. Governance, organisation and decision rights

27.1 Initial operating units

- Product and engineering;
- Commerce data and intelligence;
- Merchant success and field operations;
- Buyer growth and content;
- Ads and creator partnerships;
- Trust, safety and support;
- Finance, legal and administration.

A small team may combine roles, but accountability must remain explicit.

27.2 Minimum launch team

Indicative roles:

- product/venture lead;
- technical lead;
- two to four full-stack engineers;
- product/design lead;
- data/search engineer or strong backend equivalent;
- field/merchant activation lead;
- two to six agents or captains depending on target;
- trust/support operator;
- ads/creator commercial lead;
- fractional finance/legal/security specialists.

The plan should be adjusted to actual funding. Targets must be reduced before quality controls are removed.

27.3 Decision rights

- Product scope: product lead with executive escalation.
- Architecture/security: technical lead; security veto on critical risk.
- Verification/trust: independent trust owner with appeal process.
- Ad integrity: separate from sales quota.
- Data rights/privacy: designated owner and counsel.
- Payment/fulfilment provider acceptance: cross-functional risk review.
- Subsidiaries and white-label deals: board approval.
- Public claims and government reporting: evidence owner and executive sign-off.

27.4 Operating cadence

- daily launch operations review;
- weekly product, data and field scorecard;
- fortnightly release cycle;
- monthly unit-economics and risk review;
- quarterly strategy, competition and portfolio review;
- formal incident post-mortems.

27.5 Mission-critical execution doctrine

Shoppage is a compulsory strategic programme in the sense that leadership is committed to solving the problem, not in the sense that risks, laws or evidence can be ignored. Success cannot be guaranteed by a document; it is made more probable through disciplined execution.

Non-negotiable operating rules:

- one accountable executive owner and one weekly cross-functional launch room;
- a single binding backlog tied to v1.0 gates, not parallel wish lists;
- manual operational fallback for claims, ingestion, search correction, leads, payments and fulfilment;
- no single-source dependency for data, distribution, hosting, AI, payments or logistics;
- minimum cash/runway and contingency thresholds before expansion;
- weekly truth review covering claims, source rights, security, buyer harm and merchant outcomes;
- rapid scope reduction when a feature threatens the core search, claim, offer or request flows;
- field operations treated as a first-class product capability;
- unresolved blockers escalated with an owner, decision date and fallback path;
- no fabricated metrics, “all Zimbabwe” claims or hidden uncertainty to protect the narrative.

The answer to obstacles is not excuses and not recklessness. It is redundancy, evidence, iteration, field execution and focus.

28. National impact readiness and institutional engagement

National-scale credibility cannot be manufactured through endorsements and must not substitute for product-market evidence. Shoppage should become institution-ready through measurable, non-partisan public value, independent governance and transparent safeguards.

28.1 Public-value case

- MSME and informal-merchant digitisation;
- locally retained advertising capability and income;
- creator, agent and market employment;
- improved discovery of Zimbabwean products and suppliers;
- price, availability and market transparency;
- diaspora access to verified local commerce;
- better market and local-authority information;
- digital skills and Commerce Academy;
- export-ready supplier discovery;
- commerce-continuity information during shortages or disruption.

28.2 Safeguards

- political neutrality and no political ads in the initial platform;
- no exclusive government data access, ownership or privileged data lane;
- no government or sponsor ranking privilege in organic search;
- no surveillance backdoor or repurposing of buyer behaviour for political profiling;
- no exclusive procurement preference implied;
- aggregate public reporting, not personal surveillance;
- documented lawful-access process;
- independent correction, appeal and transparency reporting;
- public methodology for impact metrics;
- separation of commercial, regulatory and public-interest data products.

28.3 Independent Impact Scorecard and briefing pack

The primary national-scale artifact is an independently auditable Impact Scorecard, not a request for endorsement. It should report:

- active and retained MSMEs digitised;
- fresh local offers and coverage cells;
- percentage of covered searches resolved with confirmed stock or a credible request response;
- merchant advertising-wallet share and net local advertising value retained;
- creator, agent and market income;
- buyer response, complaint and trust outcomes;
- geographic and language inclusion;
- privacy, correction and transparency indicators.

The briefing pack may include a two-page impact case, live merchant/buyer/creator demonstration, 100-day scorecard, privacy and governance note, partnership menu, local-value-retention methodology and clear evidence boundaries. It should be usable by investors, DFIs, associations, municipalities, regulators, ministries and national leadership without promising political patronage or exclusive access.

29. Risk register and decision gates

Risk	Primary mitigation	Stop/escalation gate
Platform scope exceeds capacity	Narrow wedge, explicit exclusions and weekly gates	Reduce targets before removing controls
Stale or false inventory destroys trust	Freshness SLA, downgrade/hide and correction network	Suspend ads and visibility for repeat failure
Merchant activation is labour-heavy	Assisted tools, distributor feeds and agent economics	Reprice or narrow cohort if activation cost is unsustainable
Buyer demand is insufficient	Requests, creator distribution, SEO and market QR	Do not scale ad sales without organic resolution
Ads harm relevance	Eligibility floors and independent integrity	Pause product/advertiser with complaint or relevance breach
Fraud/scams	Progressive verification, anomaly detection and human review	Category/merchant suspension and appeal
Payment liability confusion	Provider-hosted processing and clear merchant-of-record terms	Disable provider/flow until reconciliation is reliable
Fulfilment failure	Mode-specific evidence and partner performance	Remove unreliable partner or service area
Data-rights breach	Source inventory, licences and access controls	Quarantine affected dataset and notify stakeholders
AI publishes unverified truth	Draft-only controls and evaluation	Roll back model/feature
Pemosites becomes an agency distraction	Shared templates and spinout gates	Stop custom work that cannot be productised
Framework opens too early	Internal-first APIs and private beta	No public ecosystem until security/reliability gates pass
Subsidiary proliferation	Admission tests and separate P&Ls	Board rejects unfunded or unproven venture
Political capture or endorsement dependence	Neutral governance, Impact Scorecard and no privileged access/ranking	Decline conditions that compromise independence
External-platform dependency	Canonical Shoppage identity/content/demand, adapters and kill-switch tests	Disable adapter and remediate if a core flow depends on it
Creator commission fraud	Fixed launch bounties, staged attribution and dispute windows	Do not enable outcome commissions until gates pass
Infrastructure cost or lock-in	Adapters, budgets and export tests	Migrate or redesign before scale

29.1 Binding decision gates

- **Launch gate:** end-to-end flows, security, data rights, support and minimum useful supply pass.
- **Ads scale gate:** repeat organic demand and attributable outcomes exist.
- **Transaction-depth gate:** payment/fulfilment reconciliation and dispute capacity pass.
- **City gate:** coverage, owner, demand, partners and budget are ready.
- **Category gate:** taxonomy, safety, supply and fulfilment are ready.
- **API gate:** stable contracts, consent, audit and revocation pass.
- **Subsidiary gate:** demand, economics, leadership and risk justify separation.
- **Capital gate:** milestones and unit-economics evidence support further investment.

30. Final business model and immediate actions

30.1 Final model

Shoppage is Zimbabwe's independent, preloaded commerce operating system: one public product for selling, discovering and growing, launched with a million-plus master catalogue, a claim-ready national organisation and place graph, known markets, historical intelligence, cold-start recommendations and a structured Request Network, then continuously converted into fresh merchant-owned offers and verified commercial truth.

Its durable advantage is the combination of:

- authoritative merchant operations;
- fresh local offers;
- structured product and variant intelligence;
- place and market relationships;
- buyer needs and unresolved demand;
- trust and outcome history;
- attributable creator and advertising data;
- payments and fulfilment evidence;
- reusable platform infrastructure.

30.2 Immediate executive actions

1. Approve v1.0 as the binding master and archive v0.7-v0.9 as source, review and consolidation history.
2. Confirm the Home, Power and Building Harare wedge.
3. Appoint owners for product, technology, commerce data, field activation, trust and commercial partnerships.
4. Complete brand, domain, company and trademark due diligence.
5. Complete Zimbabwe legal review for data, consumer, payments, ads, creators, tax and fulfilment.
6. Select and contract pilot payment and fulfilment partners.
7. Recruit the first merchant, fixed-bounty creator and market cohort.
8. Run the no-empty-platform, social-adaptor-disabled, source-removal and cold-start recommendation acceptance suites before public launch.
9. Convert the validated intelligence package into production PostgreSQL services and review queues.
10. Lock the 12-week backlog and exclusions.
11. Establish the weekly scorecard, evidence register and capital budget.

Appendix A. Prioritised 95-aim portfolio

The 80 aims remain valuable, but they are no longer described as simultaneous mandatory deliverables. They are classified as **Launch (0-3 months)**, **Expansion (4-6 months)** or **Later option (after six months)**. Every aim requires an owner and proof metric before it enters a sprint.

Aim	Horizon	Proof metric
1. Become the default local product-search habit in covered categories	Expansion	Repeat direct search and unaided recall
2. Capture measurable merchant advertising-wallet share	Expansion	Percentage of attributable spend moved
3. Retain more advertising value locally	Expansion	Net local value-retention ratio
4. Operate independently while using external platforms as optional feeders	Launch	Core-flow kill-switch pass and owned-demand share
5. Own commercial intent category by category	Launch	Resolved-need share in selected cells
6. Build Zimbabwean commercial keyword intelligence	Launch	Query success and synonym coverage
7. Establish a transparent local ad standard	Launch	Advertiser comprehension and complaint rate
8. Build a local commerce-media partner network	Later	Active publishers and partner revenue
9. Resolve needs faster than social-group posting	Launch	Median time to credible option
10. Show stock confidence instead of false certainty	Launch	Freshness visibility and error reports
11. Support exact variant discovery	Launch	Variant match and correction rate
12. Provide useful price intelligence	Expansion	Coverage and alert usefulness
13. Offer available-today discovery	Launch	Same-day availability actions
14. Automate saved needs	Expansion	Alert-to-action conversion
15. Route buyer requests	Launch	Request response and fill rate
16. Support voice-first search	Expansion	Successful voice-query resolution
17. Support English, Shona and Ndebele progressively	Expansion	Query coverage and satisfaction by language
18. Design for low data and unstable networks	Launch	Page/media data budget and completion rate
19. Compare total buyer outcome	Expansion	Comparison-to-action conversion
20. Build consent-based personal commerce memory	Later	Repeat-use benefit and opt-out rate
21. Give every merchant a credible mobile storefront	Launch	Activated Merchant Sites
22. Reduce publishing time through assisted ingestion	Launch	Median time to publish accepted offer

Aim	Horizon	Proof metric
23. Turn every product into reusable content	Launch	Content assets per active offer
24. Create a daily merchant action queue	Launch	Action completion and freshness improvement
25. Measure lead quality, not only volume	Launch	Accepted qualified-action rate
26. Preserve customer relationship history	Launch	Lead follow-up and repeat-action rate
27. Deliver actionable merchant analytics	Launch	Recommended-action completion
28. Add inventory/POS integrations	Expansion	Synced merchants and feed health
29. Build merchant team and branch management	Expansion	Multi-user/branch retention
30. Create merchant benchmarks	Expansion	Benchmark coverage and action lift
31. Build a canonical product and variant graph	Launch	Resolution accuracy and variant completeness
32. Capture branch-level local offers	Launch	Fresh local offers per coverage cell
33. Maintain evidence and provenance	Launch	Claims with complete evidence metadata
34. Maintain correction and review queues	Launch	Backlog SLA and overturned-decision rate
35. Separate candidates from verified production truth	Launch	Public-claim audit pass
36. Build coverage cells	Launch	Cells reaching usable/strong state
37. Map compatibility and substitution	Expansion	Supported category compatibility coverage
38. Capture unmet demand	Launch	Structured failed searches and requests
39. Build price and availability history	Expansion	Historical observations and alert accuracy
40. Build merchant and market performance history	Expansion	Outcome-linked records
41. Create a Zimbabwe business knowledge layer	Launch	Verified capabilities beyond ordinary directories
42. Create correction and verification networks	Expansion	Accepted correction quality
43. Protect graph from scraping and poisoning	Launch	Abuse blocks and anomaly response
44. Monetise aggregate intelligence without personal-data sale	Later	Approved products and privacy audits
45. Make self-service advertising understandable	Launch	Campaign setup completion
46. Guarantee relevance floors for sponsored results	Launch	Sponsored relevance and complaint rate
47. Measure creator links without tying launch pay to fragile attribution	Launch	Tagged-link completeness and fraud-learning quality
48. Build creator marketplace matching	Expansion	Match acceptance and outcomes
49. Pay creators through accepted-work bounties first, then verified outcomes	Launch	Bounty acceptance, rights compliance and payout disputes

Aim	Horizon	Proof metric
50. Build local creative intelligence	Expansion	Campaign improvement from recommendations
51. Launch market and area sponsorships	Expansion	Sponsorship renewal and local actions
52. Enable brand-to-stockist campaigns	Expansion	Campaigns linked to fresh authorised stock
53. Use controlled Shoppage ad credits	Expansion	Credit activation and paid conversion
54. Build campaign experiments	Expansion	Valid tests and lift measurement
55. Establish independent ad integrity	Launch	Review independence and complaint outcomes
56. Digitise markets as operating units	Launch	Useful market pages and roster freshness
57. Create Market Captain roles	Launch	Accepted work and merchant retention
58. Deploy QR infrastructure	Launch	QR sessions and attributable actions
59. Map commercial corridors and informal landmarks	Expansion	Search/fulfilment success outside street addressing
60. Build verified collection points	Expansion	Successful collections and incident rate
61. Promote market events and live discovery	Expansion	Event traffic and merchant outcomes
62. Replicate province by province using gates	Later	City/category gate pass rate
63. Build progressive verification	Launch	Predicate-level verification coverage
64. Use proof-backed reviews	Expansion	Reviews with verified evidence
65. Detect suspicious pricing and scam content	Launch	Precision, recall and human-review outcomes
66. Create category-specific safety policies	Launch	Policy coverage and incident rate
67. Support realistic payment paths	Launch	Payment-option completion and reconciliation
68. Add buyer protection gradually	Later	Reserve/process readiness and claim outcomes
69. Integrate delivery as a quoted network	Launch	Quote acceptance and fulfilment evidence
70. Measure fulfilment reliability	Expansion	Delivery/collection performance
71. Set international performance budgets	Launch	SLO dashboard and target compliance
72. Build accessible interfaces	Expansion	WCAG audit and assisted-user testing
73. Use a modular shared platform	Launch	Core reuse across five layers
74. Maintain provider and social-channel portability	Launch	Tested export, kill-switch and adapter paths
75. Create an AI evaluation harness	Launch	Model release-gate compliance
76. Keep humans in high-impact decisions	Launch	Human-review and appeal coverage
77. Use AI to reduce cost, not conceal weak operations	Launch	Cost/quality improvement without error growth

Aim	Horizon	Proof metric
78. Run continuous competitor response	Expansion	Evidence-based releases and impact
79. Build observability from day one	Launch	Incident detection and diagnosis time
80. Treat security and privacy as product quality	Launch	Security/privacy control completion
81. Launch with one-million-plus master products	Launch	Indexed masters and source partitions
82. Load at least 10,000 claim-ready organisation profiles	Launch	Profiles, source evidence and duplicate rate
83. Make every preloaded merchant profile claimable	Launch	Claim completion, disputes and time to resolution
84. Maintain national place and known-market breadth	Launch	Designated-source coverage and correction rate
85. Separate reference products from local offers visibly	Launch	False-availability incident rate
86. Build a Historical Commerce Archive	Launch/Expansion	Rights-cleared observations and usable trend depth
87. Ingest collaborator and purchased data safely	Launch	Contract coverage and rights exceptions
88. Deploy cold-start recommendations before behavioural scale	Launch	Relevance, coverage and fallback pass rate
89. Build the Shoppage Local Commerce Intelligence Model	Expansion	Evaluated local retrieval/ranking quality
90. Preserve removal and correction through derived models	Launch	Deletion-propagation SLA and audit pass
91. Measure merchant-profile claim conversion	Launch	Claimed/eligible profile rate
92. Build product compatibility and substitution intelligence	Launch/Expansion	Successful alternative/compatibility outcomes
93. Avoid single-source dependence in every core graph	Launch	Source concentration by domain
94. Use AI to enrich at scale without inventing facts	Launch	Human acceptance and hallucination rate
95. Maintain manual fallback for every mission-critical flow	Launch	Tested fallback coverage

Appendix B. Strategic extension portfolio

The framework supports many future businesses, but the portfolio is not a simultaneous roadmap.

Merchant infrastructure

Pemosites; POS and stock sync; digital catalogue/QR ordering; branch/franchise tools; CRM; quotations/invoices; bookings; content services; data migration; Business Improvement Copilot.

Commerce networks

B2B procurement; distributor portals; construction and installer network; agricultural commerce; local services; logistics/collection exchange; diaspora procurement; export-ready suppliers; Made in Zimbabwe; repair and compatibility network.

Physical markets

Market digital twins; stall/tenant tools; market advertising; events; visitor/demand analytics; collection coordination; loyalty/offers; shopping trails; municipal dashboards; vacancy and merchant-mix intelligence.

Media and advertising

Partner-publisher inventory; creator storefronts; live shopping; deal alerts; sponsored requests; brand/distributor campaigns; area sponsorships; product launches; content-production network; privacy-safe retail-media measurement.

Intelligence

Price/availability; demand gaps; merchant benchmarking; site selection; substitution/compatibility; brand distribution; informal-cluster mapping; consumer needs; supply-chain performance; public-value measurement.

Platform and developer

Commerce APIs; embeddable widgets; payment/fulfilment adapters; themes/plugins; POS/ERP connectors; white-label deployments; identity services; trust APIs; product resolution; approved AI commerce tools.

Portfolio ideas are scored on user pain, strategic fit, data contribution, revenue, capital intensity, regulatory risk, execution capacity and reuse of the core.

Appendix C. Core data entities and events

Core entities

- Person, user, role and consent;
- organisation, legal entity, merchant and branch;
- place, market, building, section, stall and service area;
- category, master product, variant, compatibility and service;
- merchant product, offer, price, inventory observation and promotion;
- media asset, clip, collection and content right;
- creator, affiliate agreement and attribution link;
- search, saved need, request, lead, quote and reservation;
- campaign, placement, spend, ad credit and outcome;
- payment intent, provider event, reconciliation and refund state;
- fulfilment quote, provider, milestone and proof;
- verification, complaint, review, dispute and appeal;
- source, evidence, licence, confidence, review and supersession;
- plan, entitlement, invoice, partner application and API credential.

Minimum event standard

Every event should capture event name, actor, organisation, object, session, timestamp, source surface, location precision, campaign/creator attribution, consent context and relevant outcome state. Sensitive values should not be placed in analytics events when a reference identifier is sufficient.

Appendix D. Source and evidence notes

1. U.S. International Trade Administration, **Zimbabwe - eCommerce**, updated March 2026: social-media-led e-commerce, Facebook Marketplace/WhatsApp, cash on delivery and mobile payments.
2. DataReportal, **Digital 2026: Zimbabwe**: late-2025 mobile connections, internet users and social-media user identities.
3. UNCTAD, **Zimbabwe eTrade Readiness Assessment**: urban/informal and diaspora-driven commerce, logistics, pickup-centre, legal and skills gaps.
4. Zimswitch official site: Zimswitch Online, recurring payment and national-switch positioning.
5. Paynow official site: merchant services and e-commerce payment solutions.
6. POTRAZ official site: Data Protection Authority, Cyber and Data Protection Act and implementation guidance.
7. Classifieds.co.zw public site: broad categories, USD/ZiG display and free-ad functionality.
8. Ownai public site: multi-category catalogue, cart, wish list and compare functions.
9. Hypermarket public site: multi-vendor positioning, trusted-vendor claims and Paynow checkout.
10. Shoppage Commerce Intelligence Foundation v0.4 and Implementation Progress Report dated 10 July 2026.
11. Google Merchant Center local inventory documentation; YouTube Shopping affiliate documentation; TikTok Shop affiliate documentation, used as global pattern references rather than Zimbabwe availability claims.
12. Cloudflare Stream, Mux and Supabase documentation, used as technical options subject to cost, rights and portability review.

Appendix E. Holistic review summary

The v0.7 model contained strong strategic material, but its append-only structure created avoidable investor and implementation risk. The review identified and corrected the following:

- repeated executive and final-decision statements;
- four overlapping implementation roadmaps;
- repeated AI, investor, risk, security and architecture sections;
- unqualified “national”, “complete” and “fully functional” language;
- possible confusion between global product references and Zimbabwe offers;
- launch-wedge mismatch with the food-product seed;
- unclear early ad-market cold-start economics;
- payment and fulfilment ownership ambiguity in earlier sections;
- merchant-site and Pemosites overlap;
- platform-ecosystem ambition that could open too early;
- 80 aims and 60 opportunities without sufficient horizon separation;
- accessibility metadata gaps in the original document;
- excessive direct formatting and non-semantic headings;
- raw URL citation labels;
- need to date and qualify current statistics and competitor features.

The v0.8 consolidation resolved these issues. The v0.9 adversarial pass made platform independence testable, simplified external brand language, staged creator compensation realistically and removed endorsement-dependent wording. The v1.0 pass locks the preloaded-intelligence launch, merchant claiming, historical archive, local recommendation model and mission-critical execution doctrine. The full block-level audit register is maintained separately for traceability.

End of Shoppage National Commerce Model - National Launch Master v1.0